

Marie Curie

A Little Girl with Big Questions

The true story of Manya, a girl in Warsaw with a head full of questions, who kept learning when she was told no and became the first person to win two Nobel Prizes.

Before reading

Look at the cover. What is the little girl holding? What questions do you think she might have?

While reading

1. Manya asked, “Why is the sky blue?” What questions would *you* ask?
2. When Manya was told girls could not study at the university, what did she do instead?
3. How did Manya and her sister Bronya help each other?

After reading

1. Marie worked for a long time in a cold shed. When have you kept trying at something hard?
2. Why do you think Marie named polonium after Poland?
3. What is one thing you would like to look at very closely?

The big idea

Why? How? What’s inside?

At dinner, pick an everyday object, such as an orange or a spoon, and ask all three questions about it together.

Try this together

A question jar. Write each “why” question your child asks on a slip of paper and put it in a jar. Each weekend, pick one and find out the answer together, in a book, outside or with a simple test.

Words to talk about

question · scientist · rays · discovery · element · Nobel Prize

Tips for reading aloud: pause on the pictures and let children notice details first. There are no wrong answers to these questions; follow your child’s curiosity. The back of the book has four simple experiments to try, and a free activity pack is at tarkasatales.com/activities.

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